[INCH-POUND]
A-A-420B
July 08, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-420A
April 10, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
RIBBON, ACCOUNTING MACHINE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This commercial item description covers black, nylon record ribbons intended for use with electric accounting machines and high speed data processing printers.

2. **Salient Characteristics.**

2.1 **Configuration.** Ribbons shall consist of a continuous length of nylon with a leader and a trailer.

2.2 **Edges.** The edges shall be straight and parallel to the warp threads. Ribbon edges shall be cut and fused. Ribbons shall be of the dimensions established by the machine manufacturer for proper operations and the contractor shall certify that the ribbons are made to the original manufacturers specifications (OEM) unless specified otherwise (see notes). The ribbons shall be firmly, evenly, and uniformly wound in cartridges, or on spools or cores designed for proper operation with the machines specified (see note).

2.3 **Weave.** The fabric shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended.

2.4 **Thickness, Thread Count and Weight:** Ribbon thickness, tread count, and weight shall be as indicated below. ASTM D 1777 shall be used to determined thickness. Edges will not be used to determine fabric thickness (see table I).

2.5 **Width.** Width shall be as specified. Ribbons shall have a tolerance of + 1/32 – 0.0 inch unless otherwise specified.

2.6 **Length.** Length shall be as specified as a minimum. Ribbons shall be furnished in continuous lengths without joining or splicing.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

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Table I.
Ribbon Thickness, Yarn, Warp, and Fill Chart

Thickness (Inches)	Total Yarn Count (min.) Threads Per. Sq. Inch	Warp Minimum Threads Per. Sq. Inch	Fill Minimum Threads Per. Sq. Inch
0.0050 ± 0.0005 inch	272	164	108

2.7 **Spools, Cartridges, & Cores.** Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, fiber core, fiber center or in a coreless configuration for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

2.8 **Workmanship.** Ribbons shall be evenly woven and free from imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance or serviceability.

2.9 **Shelf Life.** Ribbons shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling and pass the performance test as specified in paragraph 4.2.

3. **Regulatory Requirements:** The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practical, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

3.1 **Hazardous Material Requirements.**

3.1.1 **Toxicity.** Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the ribbon conforms to the above requirements.

3.1.2 **Material Safety Data Sheets.** Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

3.1.3 **Labeling.** Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

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4. Quality Assurance Provisions:

4.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 Performance Test.

4.2.1 Place a sample ribbon and place in the machine designated for its use in the contract and operate the machine in the normal manner until the ribbon has run its full course and is wound from one side to the other. During the course of the test operation, the ribbon shall be observed to ensure that it is not binding or twisting so as to interfere with proper printing. Upon completion of the test, the printed matter (the product of the ribbon printing test), shall be examined to ensure that the quality of print is uniformly dark and with no blank spots, light spots, or discontinuities. Failure to comply with any of these requirements shall be cause for rejection after testing in accordance with ASTM F 92.

4.2.2 As an alternative to the prescribed performance test, the contractor may supply a certification from the equipment manufacturer that the ribbon, identified by part number has been tested and will function properly on the equipment for which it was designed. Selected samples will then be tested on any compatible printer for the print quality defined above.

4.2.3 If the equipment manufacturer refuses to certify the ribbon or tape, then the ribbon manufacturer may then certify that the ribbon manufacturer (contractor) guarantees that the ribbon or tape will function properly on the equipment for which it has been designed.

4.2.4 Ribbon Condition (end of test). Ribbon shall withstand the test without signs of excessive frayed edges, excessive curling, or the development of holes. Excessive shall be interpreted to mean when frayed edges or curling (1) is the cause of broken characters or (2) interfere with proper ribbon feed.

5. Packaging:

5.1 Packaging, packing, palletization and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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6. Notes:

6.1 Source of Documents. The following documents form a part of the commercial item description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

6.2 Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(2) Purchaser shall specify the ribbon dimensions and shall indicate length, width, color and inking criteria (if other than specified in the CID), manufacturer's name and model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used in the procurement document. Purchasers shall indicate the original manufacturers specifications (OEM) if required.
(3) Material safety data sheets required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.

6.3 National Stock Number Listing (NSN's). The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this commercial item description. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the (CID).

7510-00-965-2445	7510-00-194-7890	7510-00-555-2537
7510-00-033-8579	7510-00-197-9163	7510-00-821-8871
7510-00-063-3743	7510-00-258-1477	7510-00-824-5619
7510-00-069-8782	7510-00-312-6125	7510-00-898-9290
7510-00-104-9337	7510-00-400-4727	7520-00-926-9204
7510-00-104-9338	7510-00-407-0299	7510-00-947-2007
7510-00-145-0089	7510-00-412-1725	7510-00-997-4319
7510-00-145-0133	7510-00-455-0418	7510-01-015-9463
7510-00-173-6631	7510-00-478-8589	7510-01-018-2862
7510-00-173-6633	7510-00-515-1103	
7510-00-181-7179	7510-00-515-1105	

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE:

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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